What its tools allow

AI agents · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Explain that an agent acts only through its tools.
- Say what a good agent does when a tool is off, missing, or a detail is missing.
- Choose which tools to give an agent for a job.

Remember

- The model reads your request and the tools list, and acts only through those tools.
- A good agent says a tool is off, says “I can’t”, or asks for a missing detail.
- Agents also guess wrongly, so every call’s details need checking.

The toolbox

1. Warm-up (5 min): What can a calculator not do?
2. Teach (8 min): Tools, details, and the four outcomes.
3. The toolbox (15 min): Groups answer requests with tool cards.
4. Tool off (7 min): Turn a card over and play again.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which tools would we give an agent? Exit ticket.

Prepare six tool cards per group and about ten request cards: four a tool can do, three no tool can do, three with a detail missing. Paper and pens are enough.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is “I can’t” sometimes the best answer an agent can give?
2. What could go wrong if an agent guessed a missing detail?
3. Which tools would you never switch on for an agent at school, and why?

Exit ticket

- Write one request a tool can do, one no tool can do, and one with a detail missing.